

Introduction

IPOR Overview

The Information Product Overview Report (IPOR) process began in 2012 with two goals: to standardize information products and to improve the quality of reports produced in field offices. Twice each year, CRD, SCB, and PSB review the core information products and communications platforms. The IPOR process alternates between qualitative and quantitative reviews. The qualitative reviews consist of teleconferences with field office to discuss challenges, global best practices, innovations, and new standards. The quantitative reviews consist of scored evaluations by product experts for each of the information products as well as “stoplight” reviews for other communications activity, adoption of new content, and innovation.

IPOR Objective

The IPOR aims to strengthen OCHA's information products and communications platforms to improve our field coordination, situational awareness, and public advocacy efforts, in line with our institutional mandate. Better products and advocacy activities at the field level help provide key humanitarian decision makers with more consistent, accurate, and timely information to save more lives. IPOR is also a key component of SCB teams' combined field support.

IPOR Audience

The IPOR is an internal document for OCHA field offices, in particular for heads of offices, communications, reporting, and information management staff. The IPOR also helps inform headquarters branches of best practices which can be spread globally and challenges faced by multiple offices that can be more quickly resolved. The IPOR is not shared with donors or humanitarian partners.

IPOR 9 Approach

IPOR 9 will be a quantitative “scored” review covering the period between January to June 2016. It will also serve as a mid-year-review for progress against OCHA strategic goals. IPOR 9 will expand its review along the information continuum in OCHA by reviewing not just information products, but also the data that supports them and the broader advocacy plans that they support. Also for the first time, the IPOR will provide feedback to offices on their level of innovation.

Historically, the IPWG evaluated all information products produced at the field level, often over 1,400 per cycle. Given that the initial goal of standardization has largely been met, and to reduce the workload on product focal points and CRD desk officers, the IPOR 9 review will only score two information products of each type produced by each field office during the period (i.e. two situation reports, two snapshots etc). These products will be submitted to the CRD product focal point Ms. Daphne Hunter (hunter1@un.org).

Technical focal points for each of the scored core products are:

- Situation Reports (SCB): Ann Weru (weru@un.org)
- Humanitarian Bulletin (SCB): David Michael Kelly (kellyd@un.org)
- Humanitarian Dashboard (PSB): Agnese Spiazzi (spiazzi@un.org)
- Humanitarian Snapshot (SCB): Akiko Harayama (harayama@un.org)

Technical focal points for the stoplight evaluations are:

- Advocacy planning (SCB): Tomas de Mul (demul@un.org)
- Common Operational Data Sets (ISB): Janet O'Callaghan (ocallaghan@un.org)
- Field office digital platforms - web, social, content produced (SCB¹): Francesca Civili (civilif@un.org)
- Innovation (SCB): David Michael Kelly (kellyd@un.org)
- Risk analysis (SCB): David Michael Kelly (kellyd@un.org)
- SADD analysis (OASG): Ann Weru / Njoki Kinyanjui (njoki@un.org)

¹ Digital asset review will include Alex Eurdolian (social media) and Christian Clark / Anna Jeffreys (content)

Timeline

- **8 August** desk officers have submitted information products for evaluation
- **22 August** product focal points have completed scoring and returned draft reports to desk officers
- **29 August** desk officers provide feedback on scoring and reports
- **5 September** IPOR 9 report draft is completed and circulated to the IPOR working Group
- **19 September** IPOR 9 final report is circulated

Field Office Report

Each field office receives a tailored report about the information products and communications activities in their country or region. Each field office report consists of three components, the operational overview, the quantitative scores and the spotlight reviews.

The operational overview, which is done by the CRD desk officer, provides the opportunity to describe external factors such as staffing gaps, surge missions, or HQ support that may have had a positive or negative impact on the quality of the IPOR products.

The quantitative scores are calculated based on a pre-determined set of criteria which have been consistent over the last three scored IPORs. These criteria are in place to ensure standardization and editorial consistency.

The spotlight evaluation is in place to reward innovation and adoption of new communication standards including the integration of sex and age disaggregated data and risk analysis into core products as well as the adoption of new website protocols and social media guidelines.

2014-17 OCHA Strategic Framework

IPOR 9 results will populate reporting on indicators which are outlined in the 2014-2017 OCHA Strategic Framework. These indicators are:

- Percentage of OCHA field offices that produce humanitarian bulletins containing risk analysis
- Average quality score for OCHA field offices information management products
- Percentage of OCHA field office core information management products that contain sex-and age-disaggregated data/ (SADD) and corresponding analysis.
- Percentage of reports issued within 48 hours following sudden-onset emergencies
- Percentage of reports issued within 48 hours following sudden-onset emergencies in countries supported by the regional office
- Percentage of new crises where inter-agency advocacy key messages have been agreed
- Percentage of field offices with an approved and yearly updated HCT advocacy and communications strategy

IPOR 9 Report

Once all field office reports are completed, the IPWG will compile the results, examine trends, and produce a report summarizing progress against objectives, areas for improvement, and highlighting the efforts of field offices that had exceptional performance in various evaluative categories. Statistics and rankings in the report will be anonymous.

Scoring Framework

Situation Report

- Correct template used (yes: 2; no: 0)
- Sources provided for information (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Needs, response and gaps information correctly presented for at least half of clusters (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Concise Situation Overview focused only on major events during the reporting period (2, 1, 0)
- Location map on page 1 showing all locations referenced in the report (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Creative use of visuals (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Quality of writing (2, 1, 0)

Humanitarian Bulletin

- Correct template used (yes: 2; no: 0)
- Sources provided for information (yes: 1; no: 0)
- At least one legible visual element (graph, photo, map, etc.) on every page (yes: 1; no: 0)
- At least half of sections longer than one para broken up by informative sub-headings (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Produced regularly and respects production schedule (yes: 2; no: 0)
- Importance/relevance of information included (yes: 1. No: 0)
- Quality of writing (2, 1, 0)

Humanitarian Snapshot

- Correct template used (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Tells one compelling story with focus on maximum three appropriate themes (yes: 1; no: 0)
- All visual elements relate back to the introduction text (yes: 1; no: 0)
- The sequence of information presented makes sense (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Spelling and grammar errors are absent (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Good design (yes: 2; no: 0)
- Information is clearly and concisely visualized (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Text is used only to explain or support visuals where necessary (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Produced regularly – at least quarterly (yes: 1; no: 0)

Humanitarian Dashboard

- Correct template used (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Sources provided for information (yes: 1; no: 0)
- Clear focus on summarizing cluster-level progress against published targets (4, 3, 2, 1, 0)
- Provides cluster-level figures for people in need, targeted and reached (3, 2, 1, 0)
- Produced regularly – at least quarterly (yes: 1; no: 0)

Stoplight Reports (green/yellow/red)

- Advocacy planning: Is there an advocacy strategy in place to inform reporting and communications activities?
- CODs: Administrative boundary data for the first three available levels (e.g. province, district and sub-district) are individually scored in six areas related to geospatial and attribute data. These ratings are then consolidated into an overall score. 'Green' requires all available layers to meet all minimum requirements.
- Field office digital platforms: Are field offices keeping their digital assets up to date with relevant, timely content? Are they using social platforms regularly and coherently with guidance provided?
- Innovation: Is the field office producing new and innovative reports, enhancing the quality of current reports or launching new reporting platforms?
- Risk analysis: Do Humanitarian Bulletins feature risk analysis, often, sometimes, or never?
- SADD analysis: Do Humanitarian Bulletins feature reporting on SADD with corresponding analysis, often sometimes, or never?